Fernbrook Labs Policy DRP-3: Data Retention and Deletion

Version 2.1. Owner: Security and Compliance. Applies to all Wayline production systems in every region.

1. Purpose and scope

We keep customer data only as long as we need it to run the service, meet legal obligations and recover from failures. This policy states how long each kind of data is kept and how it is deleted. It applies to prod-us2 and prod-eu1, and to every copy of production data, including restore points and logs.

2. Retention schedule

Event payloads: 30 days after the event is published. This also applies to deliveries in the dead-letter queue.
Delivery attempt records (status codes, response times, error messages): 90 days.
Audit logs of account and configuration changes: 400 days.
Database snapshots: a restore point is taken every 6 hours and each one is kept for 35 days.
Billing and invoicing records: 7 years, as required by tax law.

Data is deleted automatically when its retention period ends. Monthly partitions are dropped as a whole rather than deleted row by row.

3. Customer requests

When a customer closes their account, all of their data is deleted from live systems within 30 days.

Requests to erase the personal data of an individual are completed within 30 days of being verified. Restore points are immutable and are never edited to remove a single record. Erased data can therefore remain inside existing restore points until they expire, which happens at most 35 days later. If we ever restore from such a restore point, erasure requests are re-applied before the restored system serves traffic.

4. Recovery objectives

Our recovery point objective (RPO) is 6 hours, matching the snapshot interval. Our recovery time objective (RTO) is 4 hours. The infrastructure team runs a full restore drill every quarter and records the measured restore time.

5. Legal holds

A legal hold suspends deletion for the data it covers until the hold is lifted by the legal team. Data under a legal hold is still access-controlled as described in SEC-01.

6. Review

This policy is reviewed once a year by Security and Compliance.